

August 2026

Dear Mike,

I've spent a lot of years watching homes come and go in Walnut Creek, and 616 Minert caught my attention right away - a true five-bedroom ranch on a quarter-acre corner lot, with exposed beam ceilings, a Carrara Quartz waterfall kitchen, and a pool setup that most buyers spend years trying to find. When I saw the listing come off the market after 49 days without a sale, that's what prompted me to write.

Forty-nine days is close to the window where buyer psychology starts to shift, and I think the listing strategy left some real value on the table. The features here - the open floor plan, the brick fireplace with built-in seating, the solar-heated pool and landscaped outdoor spaces - are exactly what Walnut Creek buyers are actively searching for. But the listing description read more like a feature checklist than a story, and a home priced at \$1,545,000 needs to do more than list its attributes. It needs to help buyers feel what life there looks like. That gap between what the home actually offers and how it was presented is, in my view, the main reason the right buyer never showed up.

I've put together a short analysis packet that lays out the specific friction points I see in the listing history, how this home compares to the current Walnut Creek market, and the approach I'd take to a relaunch. It's not a pitch deck - it's a honest look at what happened and a concrete set of ideas for what to do differently.

If you're already working with an agent toward a new listing, please feel free to disregard this entirely - no hard feelings. But if you're still weighing your options, I'd welcome a quick call to walk you through what I've found.

With respect,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read 'Ben Olsen', with a long horizontal stroke extending to the right.

Ben Olsen

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The Path to Sold:

616 Minert Rd

Walnut Creek, CA 94598

5.0 Beds · 3 Baths · 2,211 Sq Ft · Walnut Creek

The Blueprint for a Successful Sale

Prepared For: The Owners of 616 Minert Rd

Presented By: Ben Olsen · BrightWork Realty Advocates

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A Rare Five-Bedroom Ranch with a Pool - and a Listing That Undersold Both

616 Minert Road has the kind of combination Walnut Creek buyers actively compete for: five true bedrooms, three full baths, and a ranch-style layout that puts the kitchen, dining, and living spaces in natural conversation with each other. The exposed wood beam ceilings give it architectural character that most updated ranches in this price range simply don't have. Add a solar-heated pool, mature drought-tolerant landscaping, and a quarter-acre corner lot with room to spread out, and you have a property with genuine, defensible appeal to a broad range of buyers - upsizing families, remote workers who need that fifth bedroom, and buyers relocating from San Francisco or Oakland who want space and commute access in the same package.

Forty-nine days on market for a home with these assets in this location is a strategy story, not a home story. At \$699 per square foot, the list price sat at the lower end of the Walnut Creek range for an updated property, which means the value was there to be made - but making it required marketing that built the case visually and narratively before buyers ever scheduled a showing. The listing description mentioned the right features but never assembled them into a reason to act. When buyers at this price point don't feel urgency or clarity, they wait - and waiting turns into moving on.

\$1,545,000

List Price

\$699/sqft

Price Per Sq. Ft.

None

HOA Fees

A relaunch needs to do one thing above all else: close the gap between what this home actually delivers and what buyers experienced when they encountered the listing. That means cinematic visuals that show the beam ceilings, the waterfall kitchen, and the pool in the same breath, and a narrative that connects those elements into a coherent picture of what living here actually looks like.

MARKET FORENSICS: WHY IT DIDN'T SELL

Every expired listing has a story. Here's what the listing history tells us about what held this one back, and what a different strategy would have done.

Friction #1: The Listing Never Built the Visual Case for \$1,545,000

At \$1,545,000, buyers are comparing carefully and making judgments from their phones before they ever book a showing. The features here - Carrara Quartz waterfall countertops, exposed wood beam ceilings, a brick fireplace with built-in hearth seating, and a solar-heated pool - are premium details that live and die on photography. Standard MLS angles and flat lighting leave character like this invisible to online buyers. A buyer scrolling past 616 Minert without a visual that makes the beam ceilings and the kitchen feel real is a buyer who never schedules a showing - and that buyer was the right one. The home's visual identity was never established, so it had no story to compete with.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's 3D Matterport tour lets buyers walk through the full floor plan from anywhere - a buyer in San Francisco understands the relationship between the kitchen, the living room, and the backyard before they've driven a mile.

Friction #2: The Outdoor Living Story Was Left on the Table

The backyard at 616 Minert is a genuine selling point - a solar-heated pool, drought-tolerant landscaping, mature succulents, a lemon tree, rosemary, and multiple defined outdoor areas. That's not a list of plants. That's a lifestyle. In Walnut Creek, buyers paying north of \$1.5 million are often choosing between a turnkey indoor home and one that delivers an equally intentional outdoor experience. The listing mentioned the pool and the landscaping but never showed buyers how those spaces connect - how the kitchen flows to the yard, how the corner lot creates privacy, how the copper solar system reduces the cost of ownership. The outdoor amenities were treated as a footnote instead of a headline.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Sky Tour captures the corner lot position, the pool footprint, and the yard's relationship to the home in a way that ground photography and satellite images simply cannot - buyers understand the setting before they arrive.

Friction #3: The Narrative Read Like a Feature List, Not a Home

The listing description for 616 Minert covered the right ground but never made a case. Phrases like 'comfortable everyday living and effortless entertaining' are placeholders - they appear in hundreds of listings every week and register as nothing. A five-bedroom ranch with beam ceilings, a Carrara waterfall island, a brick fireplace with built-in seating, and a private pool in one of Walnut Creek's most connected neighborhoods has a specific and compelling story. That story was never told. At \$1,545,000, buyers comparing three or four similar homes will remember the ones that felt like something - and move on from the ones that read like a form. The listing description was the first conversation this home had with a buyer, and it didn't say much.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Zillow Showcase placement pairs a professionally written listing narrative with premium portal positioning - all buyer inquiries route back to the listing team, not to a random third-party agent.

POSITIONING ANALYSIS

Metric	616 Minert Rd	Walnut Creek Market Context
Price per Sq. Ft.	\$699/sqft	\$720–\$800/sqft (standard updated range)
Lot / Setting	11,050 sqft corner lot with solar-heated pool	Typical lots 7,000–9,000 sqft; pool lots command premium
Architectural Character	Ranch style with exposed wood beam ceilings and brick fireplace	Most updated ranches in this range lack architectural detail
Premium Features	Carrara Quartz waterfall island, built-in hearth seating, copper solar pool heating	Standard inventory: updated kitchen, basic backyard
HOA	None	None typical for this neighborhood type

The verdict: At \$699/sqft versus a benchmark range of \$720-\$800/sqft, this home sits near the lower end of that range. At \$699 per square foot, 616 Minert was priced at the low end of the Walnut Creek standard updated range - which means it was arguably underpriced relative to the lot size, the pool, and the architectural character, not overpriced. The challenge wasn't the number. It was that the marketing never built the visual and narrative case that would have helped buyers understand why this home justifies that figure and more. A relaunch with the right media and story could move this home without a price reduction.

THE RELAUNCH STRATEGY: 3 PILLARS

We don't re-list this home. We relaunch it with new media, a narrative that finally does it justice, and distribution designed for the buyer it deserves.

Pillar I - Rebuild the Visual Identity Around the Beam Ceilings and the Pool

The two features that separate 616 Minert from comparable inventory - the exposed wood beam ceilings and the solar-heated corner-lot pool - were never shown the way they deserve to be. Cinematic photography that captures the beam ceiling's relationship to the open living and dining space, paired with a Sky Tour that shows the pool and corner lot in full context, gives buyers a visual that sticks. Our minimum standard is another agent's premium package, and for a home with this much visual material, that difference shows up in showing requests.

Pillar II - Write the Listing Story This Home Actually Has

Five bedrooms, three baths, a Carrara waterfall kitchen, a brick fireplace with built-in hearth seating, a private pool, and no HOA - in one of Walnut Creek's most accessible neighborhoods. That is a specific and compelling combination, and a listing description should make buyers feel it before they visit. BrightWork writes listing remarks the way a great buyer's agent describes a home to their client - not a checklist of features, but a reason to act. Buyers at \$1.5 million remember the listings that said something.

Pillar III - Put the Home in Front of the Buyers Who Are Already Looking for It

The buyer for 616 Minert is likely a family upsizing within Walnut Creek, a buyer relocating from San Francisco or Oakland, or a remote worker who needs that fifth bedroom and wants commute flexibility built in. A passive MLS launch waits for those buyers to find the listing. BrightWork's geo-targeted digital campaigns reach SF and East Bay buyers who are actively researching Lamorinda and Contra Costa neighborhoods before they've settled on a property - putting this home in front of decision-makers, not just browsers, before the first open house.

A DIFFERENT OPTION: THE QUIET LISTING

Sell Without the Disruption

A traditional listing puts a sign in your yard, opens your door to strangers every weekend, and puts your home's history on public record. For a home that already went through one listing cycle, there's a better starting point.

BrightWork maintains an active private buyer list through our off-market platform. These are Bay Area buyers who've opted in specifically to receive property alerts before anything hits Zillow. They're motivated, pre-qualified, and they believe an off-market home represents a real opportunity, which means they engage seriously.

- * **No public days on market.** The prior listing history stays private. A new buyer sees none of it.
- * **No sign, no open houses, no disruption.** The sale is a private conversation between a motivated buyer and a motivated seller.
- * **Option to go public anytime.** If the right off-market offer doesn't materialize in an agreed window, we transition directly into a full relaunch strategy with no time lost.

* HOW IT WORKS

We alert our private buyer list through offmarket.brightworkrealty.com - Bay Area buyers specifically seeking properties before they go public. If a serious match emerges within the agreed window, we negotiate and close privately. If not, we launch the full relaunch strategy immediately, with clean momentum and no days-on-market exposure.

TIMELINE: THE BRIGHTWORK SMART WAY

Phase 1 - Pre-Market Preparation (Weeks 1-2)

Staging, full media production, and a Coming Soon campaign - or a quiet listing launch to our private buyer network, depending on your preference.

Phase 2 - Strategic Launch (Week 3)

Thursday launch on Zillow Showcase with the full media package in premium placement. Targeted SF/Oakland digital ads go live the same day.

Phase 3 - Momentum Management (Weeks 4-5)

Active follow-up on every save, inquiry, and open house visitor. Final Offer gives serious buyers a transparent channel to submit competitive offers.

Phase 4 - The Close (Weeks 6-7)

We engineer competition, not just field offers. Our process keeps both sides of the transaction moving cleanly toward a close.

WHY BRIGHTWORK REALTY ADVOCATES

- * **Deep local roots:** 45+ years in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda. Ground-level knowledge of what buyers in each community are actually paying for.
- * **Premium marketing as a baseline:** Cinematic photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not a luxury add-on.
- * **Portal dominance:** Zillow Showcase and homes.com premium placement. More views, enhanced listing pages, all leads to your team.
- * **Modern offer tools:** Final Offer gives buyers a transparent path to engage and gives you real-time demand data in one place.
- * **True advocacy:** We don't re-list homes. We forensically review what went wrong and rebuild the strategy from the ground up.

This home has real assets that the market never got to properly evaluate. That's a correctable problem. The window to correct it is still open.

Ready to talk? brightworkrealty.com · (925) 255-9727

Scan to see what a relaunch looks like for your home: relaunch.brightworkrealty.com

Important Notice

If you have entered into a listing agreement or active representation agreement with a licensed real estate agent in connection with this property, please disregard this mailing.

BrightWork Realty Advocates is a licensed real estate team operated by Ben Olsen, REALTOR, California DRE License #01409268. This communication is not intended to solicit properties currently listed for sale or under active representation.

The market analysis and strategic observations contained in this report are based on publicly available listing data and BrightWork's professional assessment of market conditions. They are not a formal appraisal and should not be relied upon as a certified valuation.

All property data referenced in this report was obtained from public records and MLS history. BrightWork Realty Advocates makes no warranty as to the accuracy of third-party data sources.

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THE BRIGHTWORK ADVANTAGE

- Buy Before You Sell
- BrightFlip Pre-Sale Improvements
- Final Offer Platform
- Zillow Showcase + homes.com Premium
- Off-Market Network
- Built to Close Clean

YOUR LISTING ADVISOR

Ben Olsen

Founding Partner | REALTOR · BrightWork Realty Advocates · DRE# 02014153

Ben founded BrightWork on a specific premise: the best outcomes are built before a home ever lists. With twenty years serving the East Bay's most competitive submarkets, he's developed a clear point of view on what separates a sale that closes well from one that doesn't, and the preparation, marketing, and negotiation strategy to act on it.

He entered the workforce at 14 in construction, a background that shapes how he thinks about pre-sale decisions, disclosure strategy, and what buyers actually scrutinize at inspection. That's a different lens than most agents carry into a listing consultation.

His approach to marketing is built on the same logic. Every campaign is designed for your home's specific buyer, not the average buyer. Portal strategy, campaign integration, and buyer targeting aren't add-ons at BrightWork. They're the baseline. Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure before the home lists. The preparation is the negotiation.

20+

YEARS SERVING
LAMORINDA

\$1B+

PROPERTIES
SOLD

1,000+

BUYERS &
SELLERS

WHY HE SENT YOU THIS PACKET

When a listing expires, Ben reviews it. Not to pitch you, but because after enough of them, the pattern of what goes wrong becomes clear. If you received this analysis, he looked at your specific property and has a specific point of view about what happened. That's the conversation he's offering. No listing agreement on the table. Just a review. He'll also walk you through programs that turn seller constraints into options, and show you what a transaction designed to get everyone to the closing table feeling good actually looks like.

Why BrightWork Realty Advocates

Rooted in Lamorinda since 1977. BrightWork is built on the premise that the best outcomes start before a home ever lists. An orchestrated campaign designed for your home's buyer, not the average buyer. Programs that turn seller constraints into options. Transactions designed so everyone gets to the closing table feeling good.

That's The Smart Way to Real Estate.

EIGHT REASONS SMART SELLERS CHOOSE BRIGHTWORK

01 Superior Presentation

Professional photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not the luxury package. The baseline.

02 Premium Portal Presence

Zillow Showcase and premium homes.com membership. Higher view counts, better placement, and buyer inquiries that route to your listing team.

03 Integrated Campaigns

Every sign, mailer, and open house connects to a digital system. Curious neighbors become trackable leads.

04 Modern Offer Management

Real-time portal data guides pricing decisions. Final Offer platform for properties with strong multi-offer potential.

05 Financial Tools & Capital Programs

Capital to fund pre-sale improvements with no out-of-pocket cost until close. Plus programs that remove the timing trap entirely.

06 Off-Market Strategy

A private list of serious Bay Area buyers. Test demand quietly or gain early access before properties hit MLS.

07 Advocacy for Unsold Homes

When a home hasn't sold, we don't re-list at a lower price. We conduct a forensic review and relaunch with a rebuilt strategy.

08 Built to Close Clean

Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure to every buyer before the house lists. He structures listings to attract the best first offers from a position no one can argue with. The preparation is the negotiation.

BrightWork has served Lamorinda since 1977. Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

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Not Every Home Needs a Public Launch.

For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or a different kind of timing — BrightWork has a smarter first step.

Most agents know one approach: list on the MLS, hit the portals, hold open houses. That works for many homes. For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or more control over timing, BrightWork offers a structured, documented private path to the right buyer — built on relationships in Lamorinda that go back to 1977.

OFF MARKET SELLING HAS ITS BENEFITS

Your Home, Your Timing, No Pressure

No days-on-market counter. No public record. No nosy neighbors. Your home stays entirely private until you choose otherwise, and if you do go public later, you start fresh, with a clean slate and zero wasted days behind you.

Buyers Who Are Actually Ready

BrightWork maintains a curated list of serious, pre-qualified Bay Area buyers who have asked to be notified about Lamorinda properties. They are not browsing Zillow. Every showing is by appointment, with someone who qualifies and is genuinely interested.

Real Feedback Before You Commit

An off-market phase gives you genuine buyer response before you decide whether to close privately or step into a full MLS campaign. Either way, you move forward with real data and momentum, not day-one guesswork.

BrightWork's network of private buyers and collaborative realtor relationships has served Lamorinda since 1977.

Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

Deep relationships in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda.

WHO THE PRIVATE PATH SERVES

The Privacy-First Seller

No public listings, no open houses, and no days-on-market counter visible to buyers and agents, for whatever reason, professional or personal.

The Seller Still Preparing

Test genuine demand while staging or repairs are still underway, without burning days on market before you are ready.

The Strategically Timed Seller

Your next move depends on how this one closes. Control the sequence rather than react to a public countdown clock.

The Seller Testing the Waters

Get real buyer feedback before committing to a full public launch — or decide you do not need one at all.

Your home. Your timeline. Your terms.

Ready to find out whether the private path is the right first step?

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